StemPacker 0.3

User guide · by Elospeed · free software · ko-fi.com/elospeed

What it does: StemPacker builds Traktor stem files (`.stem.mp4`) from tracks you already have. For every song it takes one **master** file (for example your downmix) and up to **four stem files** (for example A, B, C and D) and puts them together into **one** stem file. There is **no AI separation**: your files are used exactly as they are. It works in **batches**, so hundreds of songs are packed in one run.

> **Please test with copies.** StemPacker only reads your audio files and never changes them; it writes new `.stem.mp4` files. Still, as with any new tool, please use a copy of a few songs (or a separate test folder) for the first run.

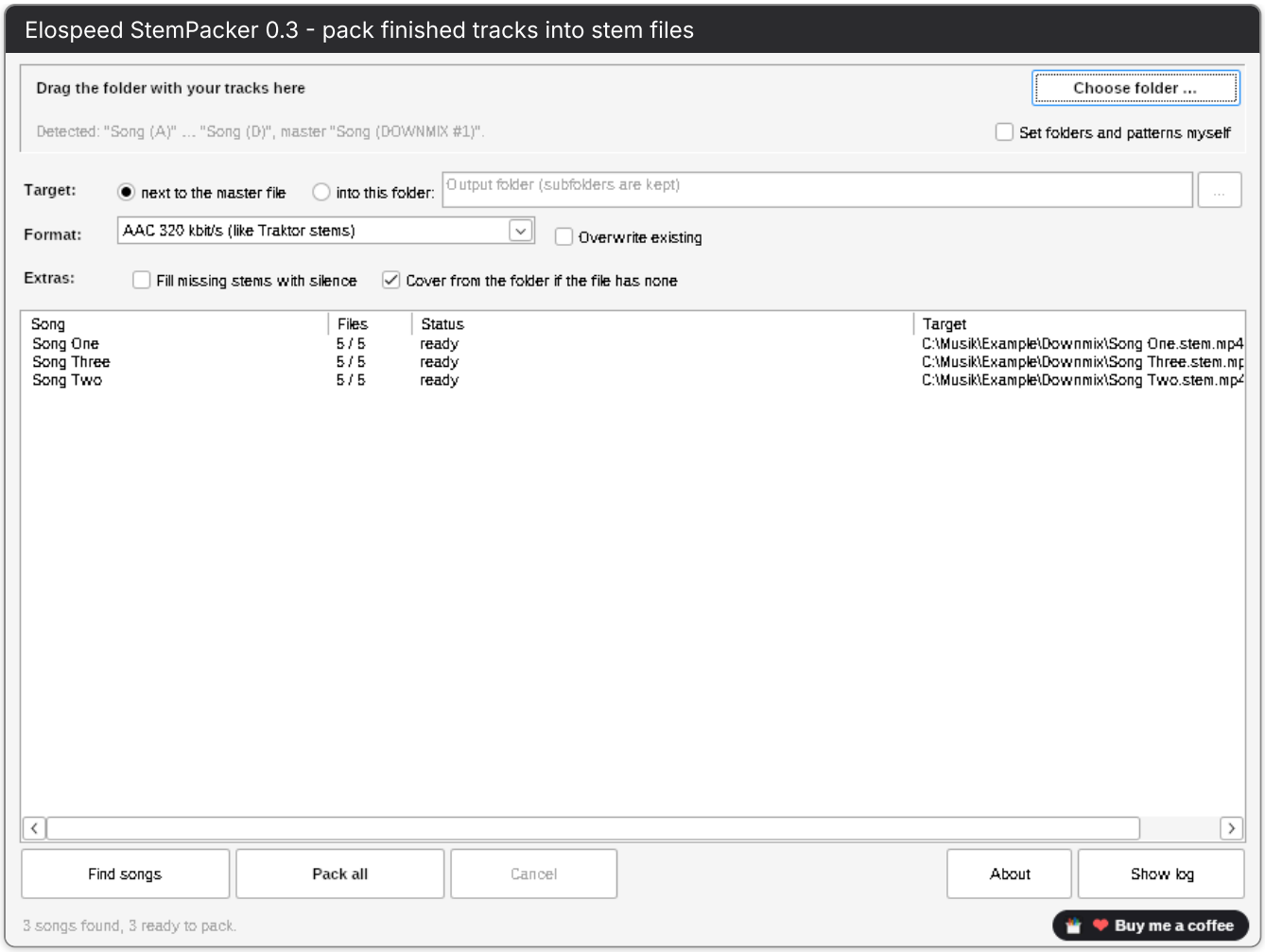
1. Getting started

1. Unzip the whole folder somewhere (e.g. Desktop). Keep the folders `tools` (contains ffmpeg.exe) and `lang` next to `StemPacker.exe`.
2. Start `StemPacker.exe`. If Windows shows “Windows protected your PC” (the program is not signed): click **More info** → **Run anyway**.
3. Nothing is installed. Settings are saved in `StemPacker.ini` next to the program.

The folder `Example` contains three short test songs (simple test tones) in the 5.1 DVD naming scheme. You can use it for a first try before using your own music.

2. Quick start: drop a folder

Drag the folder with your tracks onto the window, or click **Choose folder …**. StemPacker looks at the file names, recognises how they are named and lists the songs right away. Then click **Pack all** (section 5).



The Example folder was dropped onto the window. StemPacker found the 5.1 DVD naming: masters in `Downmix`, stems A to D in `Channels`.

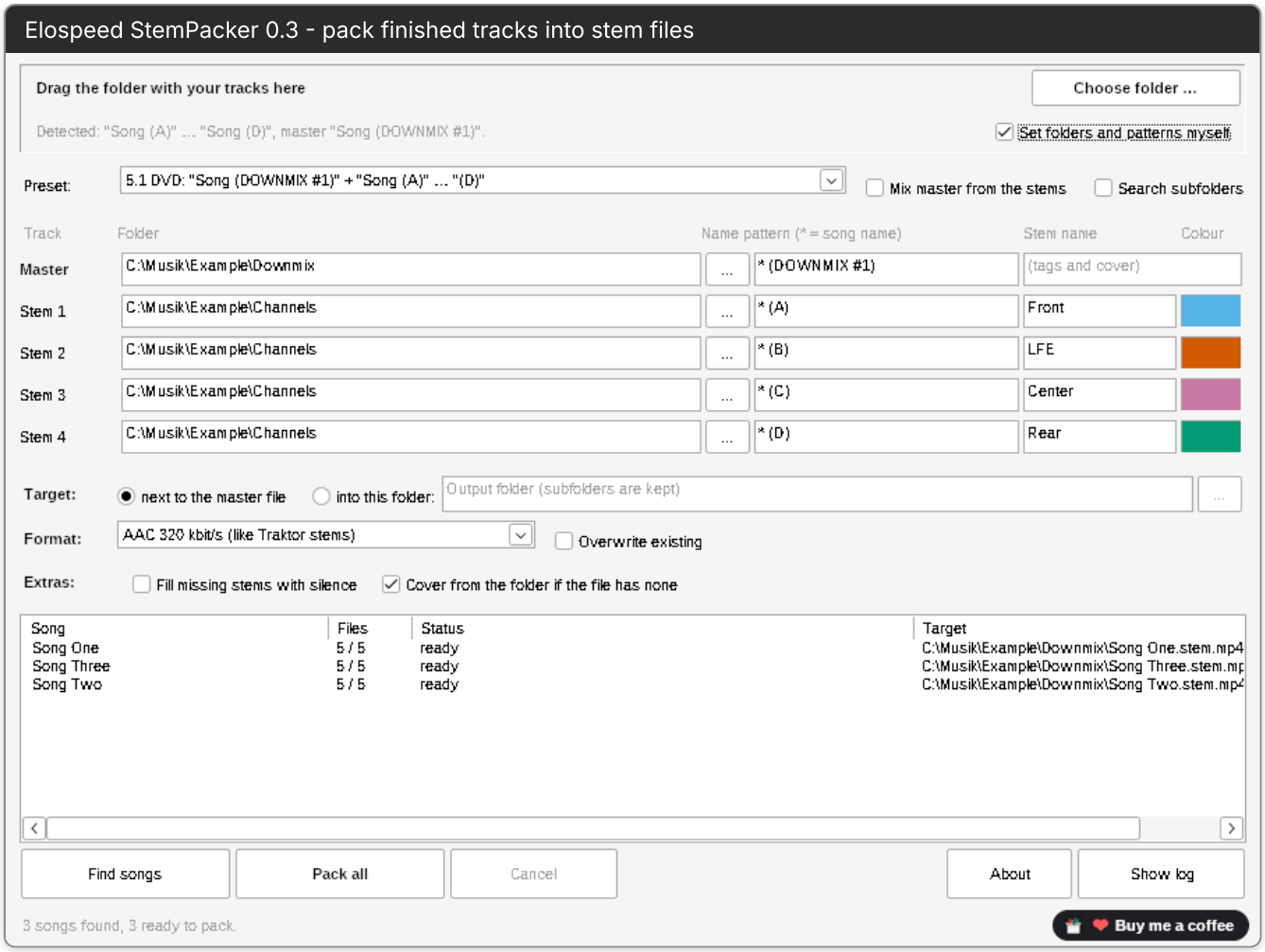
Naming	Example
Words	`Song_drums`, `Song - Bass`, `Song (Other)`, `Song [Vocals]`; also `vox`, `vocal`, `melody`, `instruments` and more. Master: `Song`, `Song_mix`, `Song - master` …
Numbers	`Song_1` to `Song_4`, master `Song_0`
5.1 DVD	`Song (A)` to `Song (D)`, master `Song (DOWNMIX #1)`

Master and stems may be in one folder, in separate subfolders (like `Downmix` and `Channels`), or in one subfolder per album. If there is no master file, the master is mixed from the stems. The line under the drop area shows what was detected.

If the naming is not recognised, StemPacker says so and opens **Set folders and patterns myself** (section 3).

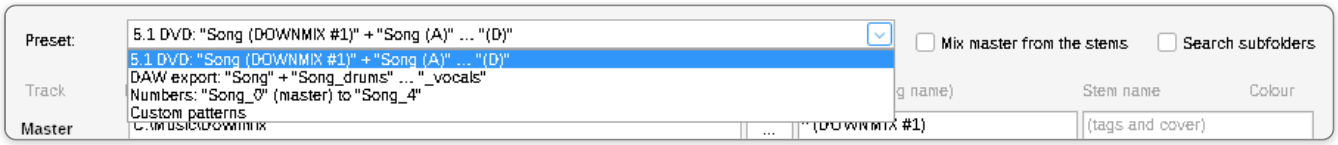
3. Set folders and patterns myself

Tick **Set folders and patterns myself** to see and change everything the quick start filled in, or to set it up by hand for unusual file names.



The same Example with the preset "5.1 DVD": master files in `Example\Downmix`, the A/B/C/D files in `Example\Channels`.

Preset



A preset fills in the name patterns, stem names and colours in one click. Your folders stay as they are.

Preset	Finds files like	Stem names
5.1 DVD (default)	`Song (DOWNMIX #1).wav` = master `Song (A).wav` … `Song (D).wav` = stems 1–4	Front, LFE, Center, Rear
DAW export	`Song.wav` = master, `Song_drums.wav`, `_bass`, `_other`, `_vocals`	Drums, Bass, Other, Vox
Numbers	`Song_0.wav` = master, `Song_1` … `Song_4`	Drums, Bass, Other, Vox
Custom patterns	Selected automatically as soon as you change a pattern yourself.	as you set them

The five rows: Master and Stem 1 to 4

Column	What it is for
Folder and **…**	The folder where the files for this row are. Type the path or click **…** to choose it. When this box is ticked, a folder dropped onto the window becomes the master folder. **An empty folder means "same as the row above"**: so if A, B, C and D are all in one folder, set it only for Stem 1.
Name pattern	How the file name looks, **without** the extension (.wav). The star `*` stands for the song name. `* (DOWNMIX #1)` finds `Hello (DOWNMIX #1).wav`, the song is then called "Hello", and the stems must be called `Hello (A).wav` and so on. Upper/lower case does not matter. A second star stands for any text that is not part of the song name.
Stem name	The name Traktor shows for this stem (e.g. Front, LFE). It is written into the stem file. The letters in your file names (A, B …) are only used to find the files.
Colour	The colour of this stem in Traktor. Click the coloured box to change it.
Master row	The master is the normal "full mix" track of the stem file (what Traktor and normal players play when stems are off). **Title, artist, album, BPM, key, cover and other tags are taken from the master file.**

Options at the top

Option	What it does
Mix master from the stems	For songs that have no master file: the four stems are mixed together (without changing the level) and used as the master. The master row is then switched off.
Search subfolders	Also looks into subfolders, e.g. one subfolder per album. The subfolders must have the same names in the master folder and in the stem folders. With an output folder, the same subfolders are created there.

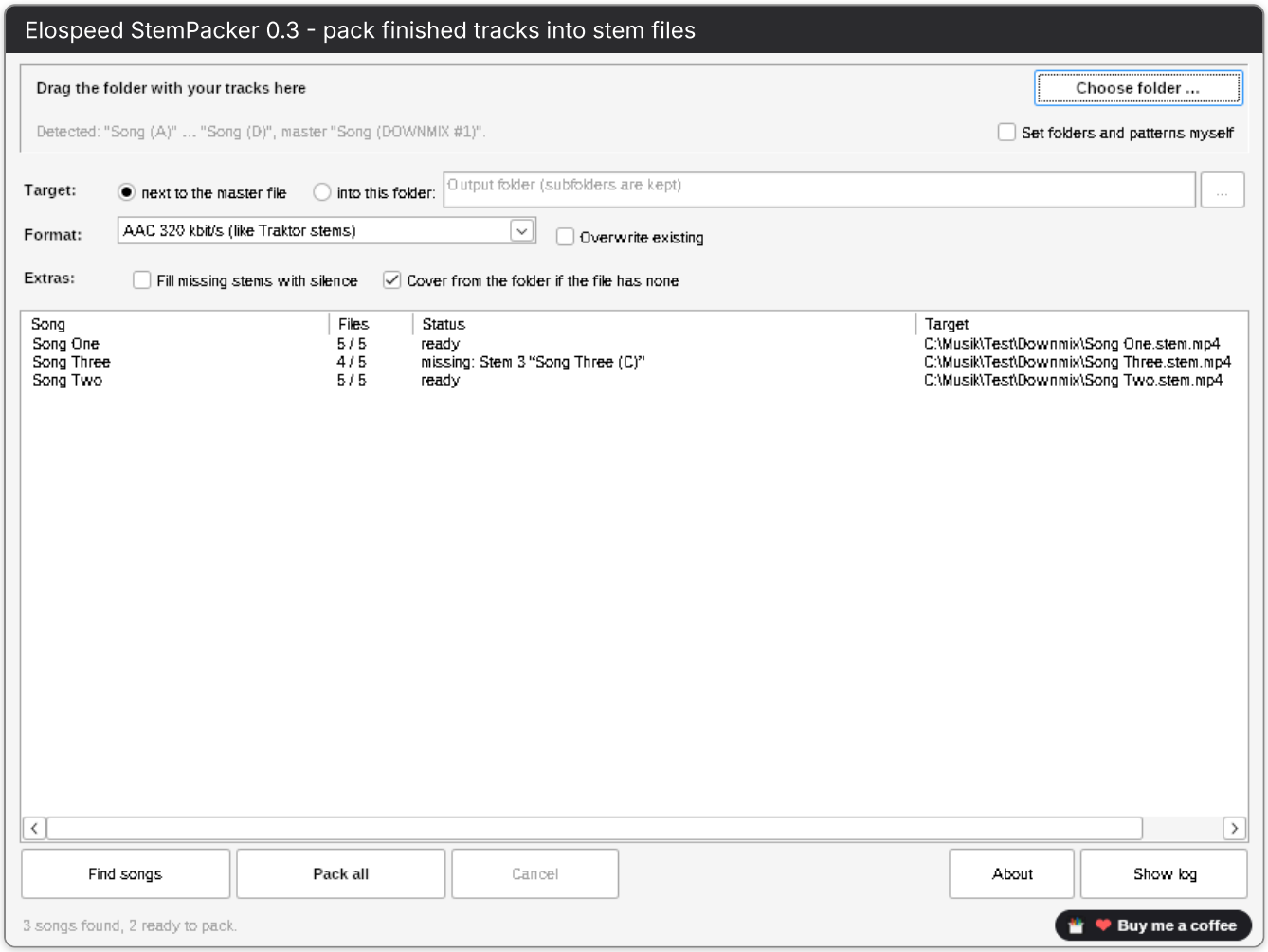
Target, format and extras

Setting	What it does
Target	**next to the master file**: the stem file is saved in the same folder as the master. **into this folder**: all stem files go into the folder you choose (subfolders are kept).
File name	Always `<song name>.stem.mp4`, e.g. `Hello.stem.mp4`.
Format	**AAC 320 kbit/s** – like the stem files from Traktor itself, small files (recommended). **ALAC lossless, 16 bit / 44.1 kHz** – no quality loss, bigger files. **ALAC 24 bit, original sample rate (test)** – keeps 24 bit and e.g. 96 kHz. **Not yet tested in Traktor**, please try one song first and tell us if Traktor plays it.

Overwrite existing	Off: songs that already have a stem file are skipped (handy to continue a batch). On: they are built again.
Fill missing stems with silence	Off: a song with a missing stem file is skipped. On: a silent track is used instead, so the song is still packed.
Cover from the folder	If the master file has no cover, an image from its folder is used: `<song>.jpg`, `cover.jpg`, `folder.jpg` or `front.jpg` (also .png).

4. The song list

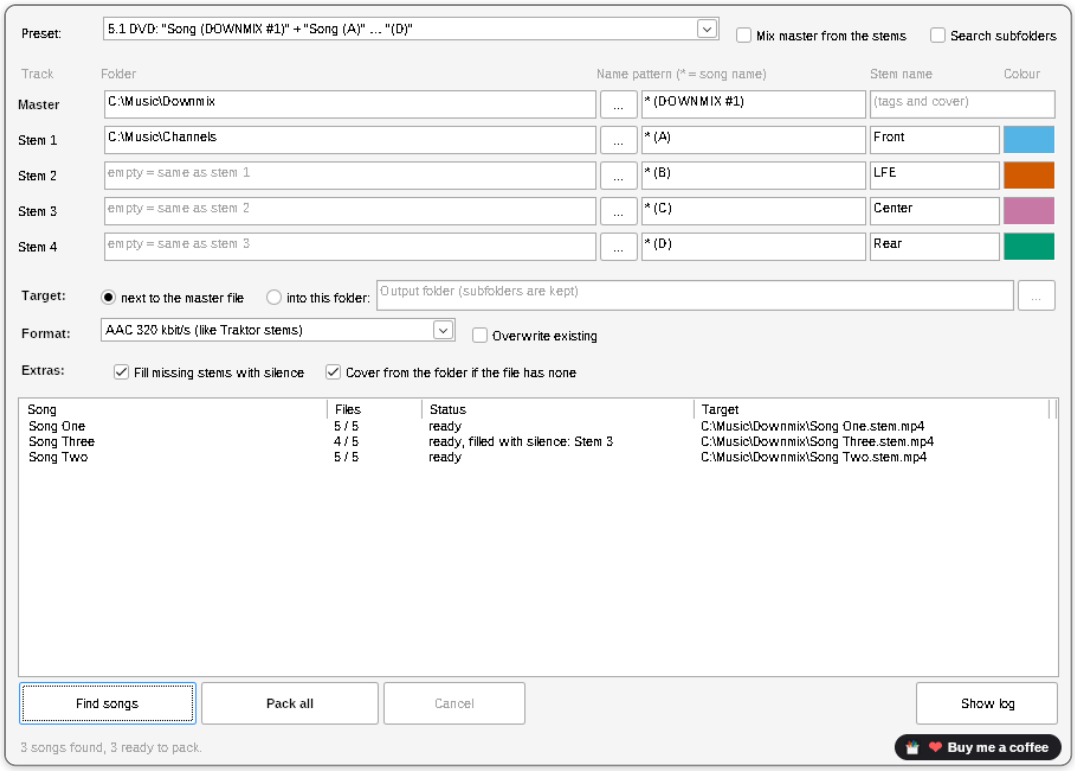
After dropping a folder, or after clicking **Find songs**, the list shows every song that was found:



"Song Three" has no C file, so it shows the name it looked for, "missing: Stem 3 "Song Three (C)"", and would be skipped.

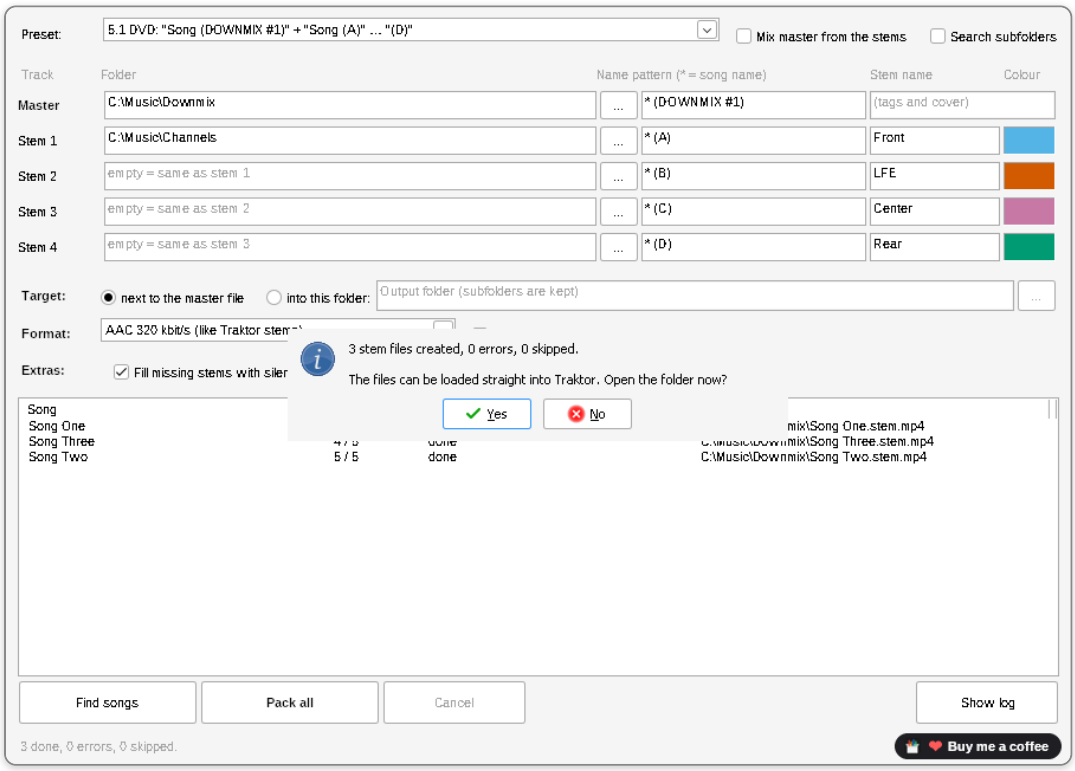
Column	Meaning
Song	Song name (the part of the file name at the star).
Files	How many of the 5 files were found (4 when the master is mixed).
Status	**ready** = will be packed · **missing: …** = file(s) not found, song is skipped · **ready, filled with silence: …** = missing stem becomes silent · **already exists, will be skipped** · after packing: **done** or an error message.
Target	Where the stem file will be saved.

With **Fill missing stems with silence** switched on and **Find songs** clicked again:



5. Pack all

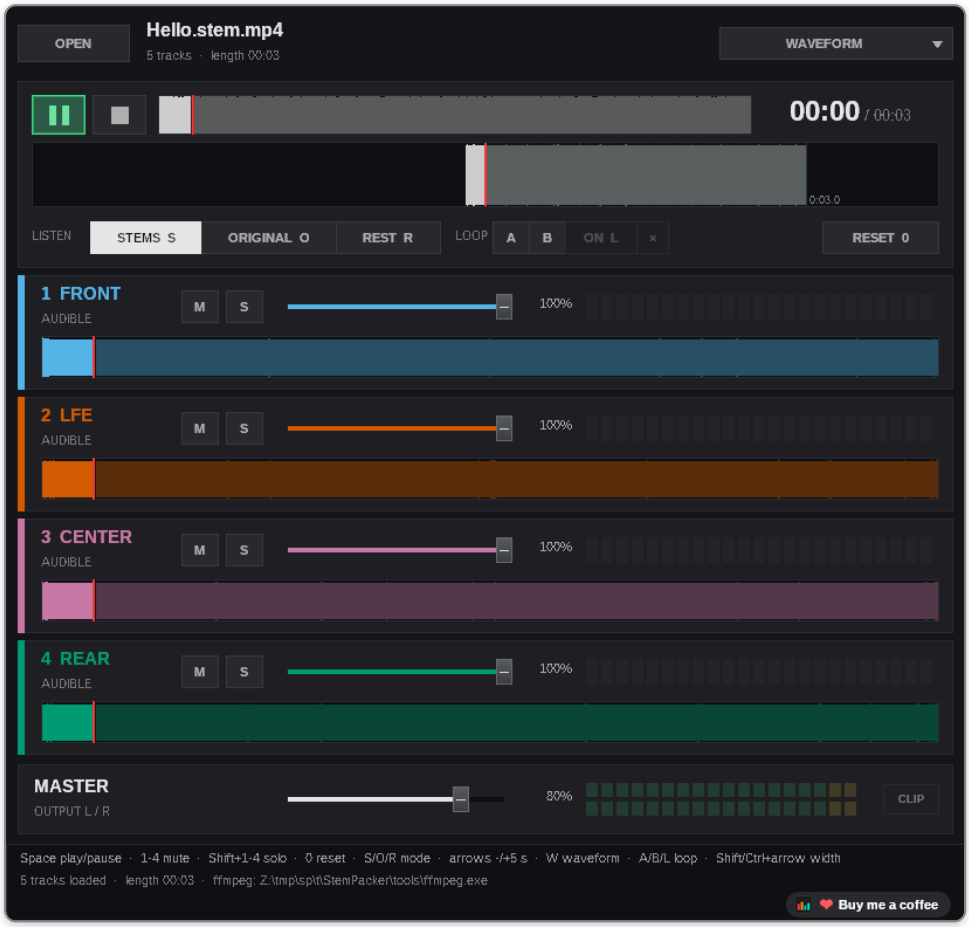
Click **Pack all**. The songs are packed one after the other; the status line shows the progress. **Cancel** stops after the current step (the unfinished file is removed). At the end you see a summary and can open the folder:



The files can be loaded straight into **Traktor Pro 4** like any stem file. Traktor shows the four stems with the names and colours you set.

6. Listen without Traktor: StemPlayer

To check a finished file before you load it into Traktor, start **StemPlayer.exe** (in the same folder) and click **OPEN**, or drop a `.stem.mp4` file onto its window. It plays all four stems in sync and shows them with the names and colours you set.



Control	What it does
M / **S** (per stem)	Mute this stem / play only this stem (solo). Keys: `1`–`4` mute, `Shift` + `1`–`4` solo.
Slider (per stem)	Volume of this stem.
STEMS / ORIGINAL / REST	Listen to the four stems mixed, to the master track, or to the master minus the stems (shows what is not in the stems).
LOOP A / B / ON	Set a loop start and end and switch the loop on or off.
MASTER	Overall volume; **CLIP** lights up when the sum is too loud.
`Space`	Play / pause.

StemPlayer only reads the file and never changes it.

7. Questions and ideas

Questions, ideas or a naming scheme that is not recognised? Write in the **GitHub Discussions** of StemMaker: github.com/Elospeed/StemMaker/discussions. Reading works without an account.

8. If something goes wrong

Everything the program does is written to `logs\StemPacker.log` next to the program. Click **Show log** to open it, and attach that file when you report a problem.

9. Folder contents

`StemPacker.exe`	the program
`StemPlayer.exe`	player to listen to finished stem files (section 6)
`StemPacker-User-Guide.pdf`	this guide
`README.txt` / `LIESMICH.txt`	short guide (English / German)
`Example\`	three short test songs in the 5.1 DVD naming scheme
`lang\`	language files (English, Spanish, French, Portuguese (Brazil), Italian, Japanese, Dutch, Polish; German is built in)
`tools\ffmpeg.exe`	FFmpeg (LGPL), does the audio work, with licence and source info
`LICENSE.txt`	licence of StemPacker (MIT)

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